

Shaurabh Anand

Assistant Professor, School of Development

Azim Premji University, Bengaluru, India

shaurabh.anand@apu.edu.in | shaurabhanand@gmail.com | +918894694487

ORCID iD: 0000-0003-3001-1918 | Google Scholar: <https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=ybaP9bQAAAAJ>

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Human-primate shared landscapes; primate behavioral ecology in human-modified environments; political ecology of land, forests and commons; environmental histories of wildlife governance in India; spatial and quantitative methods for development research

EDUCATION

- Ph.D. (Natural Sciences and Engineering) 2019
National Institute of Advanced Studies, Bangalore
- M. Sc. (Natural Resource Management) 2011
TERI University, New Delhi

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

- Assistant Professor January 2023 – Present
School of Development, Azim Premji University, Bangalore
- Working Group Member July 2024 – Present
Foundation for Ecological Security, Anand
- Research collaborator April 2021 – Present
National Institute of Advanced Studies, Bangalore
- Senior Project Associate October 2021– October 2022
World Resources Institute India, Delhi
- Post-doctoral Research Associate February 2019 – March 2021
National Institute of Advanced Studies, Bangalore
- Doctoral Researcher August 2013 – February 2019
National Institute of Advanced Studies, Bangalore

GRANTS AND PROJECTS

- Co-Principal Investigator: Exploring the Cultural and Ecological Significance of Ashwath Kattes in Peri-Urban Areas of Bangalore, funded by the Research Centre, Azim Premji University.
- Co-Principal Investigator: Another example of the inverse-care law? Studying the

status of health systems in relation to climate hazards across districts in India, funded by the School of Development, Azim Premji University.

- Principal Investigator: Assessing the drivers and impacts of crop damage by primates, funded by the School of Development, Azim Premji University.

PUBLICATIONS

Journal articles

1. Anand, S. (2026). Beyond sacred groves and ritual sacrifice. *Economic and Political Weekly*, 61(2). <https://doi.org/10.71279/epw.v61i02.47495>
2. Anand, S. (2025). The temporal trajectory and spatial variability of conservation and management of primates in India. *International Journal of Primatology*, 46(6), 1291–1320. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10764-025-00517-y>
3. Anand, S., Rajani, M. B., & Radhakrishna, S. (2025). A landscape perspective to primate crop raiding behaviour. *Landscape Research*, 1–14. <https://doi.org/10.1080/01426397.2025.2577932>
4. Sengupta, A., Anand, S., & Radhakrishna, S. (2025). Behavioural flexibility in rhesus macaques (*Macaca mulatta*) in human-modified environments. *International Journal of Primatology*, 46(4), 932–954. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10764-025-00506-1>
5. Anand, S., & Sharma, H. (2025). A Data-Driven Approach to Analyse the Status of Commons in India: A Case Study of Odisha. *Indian Journal of Agricultural Economics*, 80(3), 938–949. <https://doi.org/10.63040/25827510.2025.03.019>
6. Sharma, D., & Anand, S. (2025). Vulnerable Urbanization in Western Himalayas: A Case Study of Three Small Towns in Uttarakhand, India. *Case Studies in the Environment*, 9(1), 2463535. <https://doi.org/10.1525/cse.2025.2463535>
7. Radhakrishna, S., Anand, S., & Sengupta, A. (2025). Differing Trajectories: Understanding Coexistence Through the Human–Macaque Interface in India. *International Journal of Primatology*. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10764-025-00485-3>
8. Anand, S. & Radhakrishna, S. (2024). Does Mining Escalate Human-Wildlife Conflict?: Insights from Human-Rhesus Macaque Conflict in a Coal-Mining Region in Southern India. *Human Ecology*, 52, 129–141. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10745-024-00481-w>
9. Anand, S. & Radhakrishna, S. (2022). Collective movement decision-making in primates in crop- raiding contexts, *Behavioural Processes*. 196, 104604 <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.beproc.2022.104604>
10. Anand, S., Vaidyanathan, S. & Radhakrishna, S. (2021). The role of landscape structure in primate crop feeding: Insights from rhesus macaques (*Macaca mulatta*) in Northern India. *International Journal of Primatology*. 42(5), 764–780 <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10764-021-00238-y>
11. Anand, S. & Radhakrishna, S. (2020). Is human–rhesus macaque (*Macaca mulatta*) conflict in India a case of human–human conflict?, *Ambio*, 49, 1685–1696. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13280-020-01324-w>
12. Anand, S., Binoy, V. V. & Radhakrishna, S. (2018). The monkey is not always a God: Attitudinal differences toward crop-raiding macaques and why it matters for conflict

mitigation, *Ambio*, 47 (6), 711–720. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13280-017-1008-5>

13. Anand, S. & Radhakrishna, S. (2017). Investigating trends in human-wildlife conflict: Is conflict escalation real or imagined? *Journal of Asia-Pacific Biodiversity*, 10, 154–161. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.japb.2017.02.003>

Book Chapters

1. Anand, S., & Srinivasaiah, N. (2020). Governance of wildlife in India. In A. S. Raju (Ed.), *Understanding governance in South Asia* (pp. 227–240). Routledge. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003095149>

Manuscripts under review and in preparation

1. Gopi Sankar, G., Anand, S., & Kumar, N. (under review). Horticultural expansion in India: Regional growth and sub-regional. *Economic and Political Weekly*.
2. Ghosh, T., Anand, S., Nannewar, R. G., & Nagaraj, N. (under review). One-Day-Ahead rainfall-field prediction across four Indian cities: Comparing ConvLSTM with alternative forecasting approaches
3. Pradyumna, A., Narayanan, S., & Anand, S. (in preparation). Prioritization of climatic hazards from a health perspective: A conceptual exploration using India as a case study
4. Anand, S. (in preparation). Commentary on the absence of formal primatology training in India. *International Journal of Primatology*, special issue on primatology education.
5. Anand, S., Nagesh, S. & Radhakrishna S. (in preparation). Behavioural Plasticity and Social Network Dynamics: How Bonnet Macaques (*Macaca radiata*) Negotiate a Human-Modified Landscape.
6. Anand, S., Kumar, S. & Jyotishi, A. (in preparation). Community Forest Rights implementation in Kalahandi district, Odisha.
7. Anand S., Krishnan, S. & Guha, P. (in preparation). Village-level deprivation and terrain-adjusted market access across selected states in India.

FIELDWORK AND STUDY SYSTEMS

- Bonnet macaque (*Macaca radiata*): Human-modified agricultural and plantation landscape, southern Karnataka. April 2024 – May 2025. Behavioral observation (256 hours), household survey (n=300).
- Rhesus macaque (*Macaca mulatta*): Forest-Agriculture mosaic landscapes, Solan, Himachal Pradesh. March 2016 – June 2017. Behavioral observation (325 hours), household survey (n=729); interviews with forest department staff (n=135).
- Rhesus macaque (*Macaca mulatta*): Coal-mining landscape, Mancheria and Pedapalli, Telangana. 2019. Household surveys (n=831).

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Anand, S., & Suresh, L. (2026, June 8–11). Mapping the commons: Addressing data gaps and epistemological challenges in India's land governance [Conference presentation]. 6th India Public Policy Network (IPPN) Conference, National Law School of India University, Bengaluru, India.
- Anand, S., & Radhakrishna, S. (2018) How dependent is the rhesus macaque on agroecosystems? Insights for mitigating human-rhesus macaque conflict in India. Presentation at the XXVII Congress of the International Primatological Society, Nairobi, Kenya, 19th to 25th August 2018
- Anand S. (2017) Wildlife sterilisation to manage human-wildlife conflict. In International Conference on Environmental Challenges for the 21st Century. Zakir Hussain College, University of Delhi. 29-30 March 2017

INVITED TALKS

- Anand S. (2018) Primate population control and human-rhesus-macaque conflict, Workshop on 'Human-rhesus macaque interface', Shimla, Himachal Pradesh. Organized by Himachal Pradesh Forest Department, 8 August 2018

POPULAR WRITING AND SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

- Anand, S., & Singh, S. (2026, March 23). Sahariya Adivasis face the risk of double displacement [Commentary]. Mongabay. <https://india.mongabay.com/2026/03/sahariya-adivasis-face-the-risk-of-double-displacement-commentary/>
- Anand, S. (2026, March 12). The wild in the city: What citizen scientists tell us about Bengaluru's biodiversity. Citizen Matters. <https://citizenmatters.in/what-citizen-scientists-tell-us-about-bengalurus-biodiversity-data/>
- Anand, S. (2024, May 9). Shouldering our fellow beings' presence: Human-primate coexistence in India. Azim Premji University. <https://azimpremjiuniversity.edu.in/faculty-perspective/the-case-of-human-primate-coexistence-in-india>
- Anand, S. (2023). Shared space: Coexisting with primates in India. Azim Premji University. <https://azimpremjiuniversity.edu.in/shared-space-coexisting-with-primates-in-india>
- Anand, S., & Madhav, S. (2021, August 25). Switch it off!: How light pollution disorients ecosystems. Down To Earth. <https://www.downtoearth.org.in/pollution/switch-it-off-how-light-pollution-disorients-ecosystems-78631>

EDITORIAL AND PEER REVIEW SERVICE

Guest editorship

- Guest Editor, Special Issue: Managing and Understanding Synanthropic Primates,

International Journal of Primatology, 46(6), 2025. Co-editors: Paula A. Pebsworth, Kerry McAuliffe Dore, Malene F. Hansen, Dietmar Zinner. 12 articles. Issue developed from the symposium "Abundant Primate Populations: Challenges & Strategies for Coexistence," XXIX Congress of the International Primatological Society, 2023.

- Editorial introduction: Pebsworth, P. A., Dore, K. M., Hansen, M., Anand, S., & Zinner, D. (2026). Introduction to the special issue on managing and understanding synanthropic primates. International Journal of Primatology, 46(6). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10764-025-00531-0>

Peer review

- PLOS ONE, Biotropica, Resonance, International Journal of Primatology

Conference abstract review

- Student Conference on Conservation Science, Bengaluru

TEACHING, CURRICULUM DEVELOPMENT AND SUPERVISION

Courses taught - Azim Premji University, 2023 – present

Designed

- Spatial Analysis (MTH-238): Elective course for MA in Development. January 2024, July 2024, July 2025, July 2026
- Landscape: Patterns, Processes and Impacts on Development (LIH-245): Elective course for MA in Development. Anand. January 2025, January 2026

Co-designed

- Quantitative Data Analysis for Development (MTH-205): Course for Certificate program in Quantitative Analysis and Data Visualization. May 2025
- Data Analysis and Visualization using R (TCH-204): Course for Certificate program in Quantitative Analysis and Data Visualization. May 2026

Taught

- Understanding Development Realities through Data (DEV-220): Core course for MA in Development. July 2024, July 2025

Courses designed, not yet offered

- Living with Wildlife in Shared Spaces: Elective for MA in Development. Under review, Course Review Committee, 2026.
- Spatial Intelligence for Managers: Elective course for MBA in Development Management. Under review, Course Review Committee, 2026.

Teaching materials developed

- Progressive R curriculum for quantitative methods: Annotated scripts covering descriptive statistics through multiple and logistic regression, regression diagnostics, categorical variables and interaction terms
- QGIS lab worksheet series using open Indian administrative, census and remote-sensing data.

Supervision - Azim Premji University, 2023 – present

- Winter Field Projects supervision, MA in Development, 10 individual student projects. Selected projects:
 - Stuti Singh (2026). Perceptions and Attitudes of the Local Communities living around Kuno National Park towards Cheetahs and Other Wildlife
 - Vanshika Malani (2026). Heat, community, and everyday life: How do residents of slums in Kolkata use social infrastructure to cope with heat, and what factors shape access to these spaces?
 - Shubham Petale (2026). Understanding the impacts of ecotourism on the local economy around Tadoba tiger reserve
 - Vaishnavi Paliya (2025). River into Sewage: Degradation of Swarna Rekha River in Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh
 - Rachel Elizabeth Thekkanath (2024). The Sea, Shore and its People: A study on the influence of coastal erosion on fisherfolk in select few coastal villages of Thiruvananthapuram.

INSTITUTIONAL SERVICE

- Member, Institutional Review Board (IRB), School of Development, Azim Premji University. 2024 – present
- Admissions panel member, MA in Development, Azim Premji University. 2023 – present

TECHNICAL AND METHODOLOGICAL SKILLS

Field methods

- Behavioral sampling of free-ranging primates (scan, focal, all-occurrence, group follows, habituation)
- Household and farmer surveys; semi-structured and key informant interviews
- Plot-based vegetation assessment

Analytical methods

- Quantitative analysis: Linear, logistic and multilevel regression; analysis of large administrative and survey datasets (Mission Antyodaya, Census, NFHS, SHRUG)
- Spatial and remote sensing: Proximity analysis, accessibility analysis, network analysis, Land use classification and modelling, landscape characterization, fragmentation analysis
- Computational text analysis: Named entity recognition (NER) and annotation of ecological literature; corpus construction and text classification
- Qualitative and archival: thematic analysis of interview material; policy, legislative and archival document analysis

Software

- R, Python, QGIS, Google Earth Engine, ODK, KoboCollect

Languages

- Bhojpuri (first language, field research)
- Hindi (fluent; academic and popular writing, field research)
- English (academic and popular writing)

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- Member, American Society of Primatologists (ASP)
- Signatory and co-author of the international "Declaration on the Rights of Non-Human Primates"
- Member, study advisory board, Center for Social Ecology (CenSE)